

Carter Buckner

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Fayetteville, AR, US

Professional Summary

MS Computer Science graduate specializing in secure and privacy-preserving ML, and explainable AI/ML. 3-year research and project experience in anomaly detection, adversarial ML, trustworthy AI/ML, and translating technical insights into data governance and model compliance (with US NIST). Proven collaborator and communicator across multi-institutional security and privacy initiatives and community workshops on AI ethics, data policy, and technical works. Passionate about connecting policy, trust, and security/privacy in real-world AI deployment.

Work Experience

Research Assistant

Qinghua Li, advisor | University of Arkansas

focus: privacy-preserving AI

Jan 2022 – Dec 2025

- Focus in explainable, privacy-preserving AI, and ML-based vulnerability detection for image and tabular models
- Improved privacy and model utility for ML systems under differential privacy
- Collaborated with 5 member schools to identify and mitigate web vulnerabilities in energy grids
- Lead collaborator in project with school of public policy to survey young adults in 4 states on AI adoption and privacy behaviors

Teaching Assistant, University of Arkansas

Aug 2025 – Dec 2025

Database Management Systems (CSC 45203)

- Hosted office hours, graded homework assignments, and tests for 80 students
- Provided feedback on SQL best practices and logic
- Helped debug code samples with students

Technology Software Intern, Northrop Grumman Corporation

May 2019 – June 2022

- Conducted software unit testing for aircraft systems supporting US Air Force (TS Clearance)
- Developed cross platform internal web applications (cross-platform and Windows)
- Work done observing agile and scrum frameworks, and secure coding best practices

Student Research Assistant

Aug 2018 – Dec 2019

Alexander Nelson, advisor | University of Arkansas

focus: rehabilitative IoT Devices

- Applied homomorphic encryption in a project exploring secure multi-party communication
- Developed privacy-preserving data collection methodologies for rehabilitative devices
- Evaluated security vulnerabilities in IoT device communications

Research Intern

May – Aug 2018

Ian Harris, advisor | University of California, Irvine

focus: rehabilitative IoT Devices

- Prototyped low-energy digital IoT device for medical prosthetics
- Collaborated with UCI Medical School on design and use cases

Skills Summary

Relevant Languages/Scripting: Python, Bash

Relevant Tools: Pytorch, Lightning, TensorFlow, Scipy, Sklearn, Slurm, Linux, Git, SQL, Weights & Biases

Education

M.S. Computer Science | *focus:* privacy-preserving AI

Aug 2022 – Dec 2025

Qinghua Li, Advisor | University of Arkansas

B.S. Computer Science, Minor Music

Dec 2021

University of Arkansas

Publications

Challenges to Grassroots Organization Engagement with AI Policy

Feb 2026

Carter Buckner, Queer in AI, et al.

ACM Conference on Fairness, Accountability, and Transparency 2026

Towards Trust in Privacy-Preserving Systems

Dec 2025

Carter Buckner, Qinghua Li

Master's Thesis

Rural Privacy Desires in the U.S. South

Carter Buckner , Izehi Oriaghan, Larissa Rocha, Kadesha Treco, Anna Zajicek, Qinghua Li
Midwest Political Science Association 2025

Mar 2025

Teaching, Presentations, Talks

Troubling Translation: Sociotechnical Expertise and Research in AI policy and Governance

Jun 2025

ACM Conference on Fairness, Accountability, and Transparency 2025, Athens, Greece

Participatory AI and Data Governance

Dec 2024

Queer in AI Workshop @ NeurIPS '24, Vancouver, BC

NIST National AI Advisory Council Briefing

July 2024

Queer in AI

Talk, Symposium on Surveillance: “From Surveillance to Visibility”

Apr 2024

Digital Humanities, University of Arkansas

Guest Lecturer, Intro to Digital Humanities Course

Sep 2023

Digital Humanities, University of Arkansas

Extracurriculars, Volunteerism, and Leadership

US Policy Lead

Jan 2024 – *present*

Queer in AI

Section Member, Bass

Jan 2023 – *present*

Symphony of Northwest Arkansas (SoNA)

Eagle Scout Rank

Apr 2017

Boy Scouts of America